Hwee Jean (Cindy) Lim

EDUC 5030: Designing Effective Learning Environments

Project 2: Instructional Materials Development

Ethical and Transparent AI Use in College Composition

This instructional module, Ethical and Transparent AI Use in College Composition, is a 1–2 week learning sequence designed to address the growing challenge of evaluating and supporting student writing in contexts where AI-generated text is increasingly prevalent. The module provides explicit instruction in critically evaluating AI output, documenting AI use transparently, and maintaining authorship through rhetorical decision-making. The module is designed for undergraduate composition students with limited prior instruction on the ethical use of AI, and is adaptable for in-person, hybrid, or online learning environments. Activities and assessments are structured to support linguistically diverse learners while reinforcing academic integrity, equity, and confidence in independent writing.

Module Outline

Module Title: Ethical and Transparent AI Use in College Composition
Duration: 1–2 weeks
Delivery Context: In-person, hybrid, or online undergraduate composition course
Target Learners: Undergraduate composition students, including native and non-native English speakers, with limited prior instruction on ethical AI use in academic writing

Module Learning Objectives

- Evaluate AI-generated text for accuracy, bias, and rhetorical appropriateness in academic writing contexts.
- Apply institutional and course AI-use guidelines through transparent documentation of AI interactions.

- Compose and revise an original argumentative text that demonstrates independent rhetorical decision-making while using AI as a constrained support tool.

Module Outline

Day	Instructional Focus and Activities	Materials and Assessment
Day 1 Orientation to AI, Authorship, and Academic Integrity	Introduce institutional AI guidelines, authorship expectations, and equity considerations. Students examine short case scenarios illustrating ethical and unethical AI use and participate in a guided discussion to surface assumptions and concerns about AI in academic writing.	Slides outlining policy and authorship principles, as well as case scenario prompts. Assessments: Low-stakes discussion post or short quiz to confirm understanding of expectations.
Day 2 Evaluating AI-Generated Text	Develop students' ability to critically analyze AI-generated writing for accuracy, bias, tone, and rhetorical fit. Instructor models text analysis, followed by collaborative annotation and whole-class synthesis of observed patterns in AI and human writing.	Paired AI and human writing samples; AI-text evaluation checklist; shared annotation tool. Assessments: Formative analysis activity graded for completion and engagement.
Day 3 Documenting AI Use Transparently	Focus on making AI interactions visible through structured documentation. Instructor models an AI-use log entry, and students begin documenting their own AI use	AI-use log template; example completed log entry. Assessments: Mid-unit AI-use log review with formative instructor feedback.

	while discussing ethical decision-making and revision choices.	
Day 4 Drafting with Constrained AI Support	Guide students through drafting an argumentative essay while using AI in documented ways. Students apply prior evaluation skills and participate in peer discussion of drafting and AI-supported strategies.	Drafting guide or outline worksheet; peer discussion prompts. Assessments: Draft or outline with documented use of AI.
Day 5 Revision, Reflection, and Ethical Authorship	Justification of AI-supported revisions and reflection on authorship and ethics. Students participate in structured peer review, revise their essays, and complete a reflective analysis of their use of AI.	Peer review checklist; reflection prompt; rubric. Assessments: Final argumentative essay and annotated AI-use log with reflection.

Lesson Plan

Duration

One 75-minute session (or two 50-minute sessions if hybrid or asynchronous).

Learning Objectives

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

1. Identify features that distinguish AI-generated from human-written text.
2. Evaluate AI writing for accuracy, bias, linguistic appropriateness, and rhetorical effectiveness using digital annotation and analysis tools.
3. Reflect on how language and discourse choices in AI output inform ethical and transparent writing practices.

Technology Tools

- ChatGPT for live generation of AI text samples.
- Canvas LMS Discussion Board for collaborative posting of group findings.
- Google Docs for shared digital annotation of AI and human samples.
- Mentimeter to activate prior knowledge and collect perceptions.
- Padlet for student reflection submissions.

Lesson Sequence

1. Pre-Instruction (10 minutes)

- Launch a Mentimeter poll: “Can you tell if writing is AI-generated?”
- Discuss results and highlight common assumptions about AI writing style and tone.
- Introduce the purpose: to evaluate AI-generated text critically for reliability, linguistic form, and rhetorical fit.

Facilitation Note:
In NS-dominant classes, prompt discussion on *stylistic precision* and *voice consistency.*
In NNS-dominant classes, emphasize *register* and *lexical appropriateness* in academic contexts.
In mixed classes, balance both by asking: “What feels natural or convincing to you as a reader?”

2. Instructor Demonstration (15 minutes)

- Use ChatGPT to generate a paragraph (e.g., “Explain the role of AI in academic writing”).
- Display it next to a human-written paragraph on the same topic drawn from a previous course assignment (anonymized).
- Annotate both using Google Docs comments, focusing on lexical choice and sentence structure, and bias and accuracy.
- Think aloud about what is being noticed with regards to sentence patterns, paragraph structure and distribution, consistency of tone and voice, and specificity vs generality.

Facilitation Note:
If most learners are NNS, explicitly model noticing of academic collocations ("play a role in," "pose challenges to").
If NSs are dominant, model attention to *syntactic variation* and *rhetorical stance*.
In all cases, frame the analysis as an exploration of *how language performs credibility* in academic writing.

3. Collaborative Practice (25 minutes)

- Groups annotate paired AI and human texts in a shared Google Doc.
- They apply the AI-text evaluation checklist, focusing on linguistic and rhetorical features.
- Encourage group members to comment on specific phrasing, transitions, or tone shifts.
- Each group posts one key observation to the LMS discussion board.
- Instructor circulates (in person or online), prompting comparisons such as:
  "Which phrasing better fits academic writing?" or "Does this sound formal or mechanical?"

Facilitation Note:
In mixed-linguistic groups, assign balanced roles (e.g., *tone reviewer*, *cohesion reviewer*, *evidence reviewer*).
In homogenous groups, scaffold linguistic noticing differently:

- NNS-majority: focus on identifying natural phrasing and cohesion markers.
- NS-majority: focus on precision, nuance, and audience awareness.
  This keeps peer dialogue equitable and purposeful across class types.

4. Whole-Class Debrief (10 minutes)

- Review group findings, highlighting shared trends.
- Use a Padlet or LucidChart to categorize issues (e.g., "lexical range," "bias," "authorship tone").
- Facilitate a short discussion: "What might this reveal about AI's grasp of audience or rhetorical intent?"

Facilitation Note:
Adapt questioning depth based on linguistic mix:

- NNS-dominant: discuss language accuracy and clarity.
- NS-dominant: discuss stylistic depth and rhetorical subtlety.
- Mixed: emphasize *reader perception*—what each finds convincing or awkward.

5. Reflection and Transfer (10 minutes)

- Students complete a Padlet or Google Form reflection:
  "What linguistic or stylistic features made AI writing sound less authentic? How might you use this awareness in your own drafts?"
- Instructor reviews responses to guide the next session on AI-use documentation.

Instructional Materials:

- AI-generated writing sample created live using ChatGPT
- Human-written academic paragraph on the same topic (anonymized sample)
- AI-text evaluation checklist (digital or printable)
- Shared Google Doc for collaborative annotation
- Mentimeter poll for pre-instruction activation
- LMS discussion board for group observations
- Padlet or LucidChart for whole-class synthesis
- Reflection prompt delivered via Padlet or Google Form